

Teaching Portfolio

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Teaching identity

Political economy and applied macroeconomics, taught through structured, evidence-based pedagogy that pairs analytical rigor with scaffolded student support.

Portfolio note.

This portfolio documents teaching and mentorship experience across multiple institutional contexts (2016–2024), including teaching assistantships, instructor-of-record roles, and faculty appointments. Evidence includes course evaluations, open-ended student feedback, and mentoring outcomes. Evaluation instruments vary by institution (1–5, 1–9, 1–5), and results are reported transparently with scales and response rates where available.

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1 Teaching Identity and Philosophy

I teach political economy as a way of learning how to explain the world carefully. Not by reciting concepts, but by tracing how economic outcomes emerge from institutional design, power relations, and historical change. If students leave my courses with one durable skill, it is the ability to construct an argument that connects structure to experience—clearly, patiently, and with evidence.

Structure matters to me, but not as rigidity. I rely on analytical progression, short writing cycles, and steady feedback because explanation improves through repetition. My courses are designed so that thinking becomes a habit: reading leads to writing; writing leads to discussion; discussion leads to synthesis. Over time, this rhythm produces clarity under constraint—time constraints, evidentiary limits, and competing interpretations.

Three commitments organize this approach.

Structured Analytical Progression

I build courses around a stable weekly cadence. Students know what is expected, when it is expected, and how it will be evaluated. Predictability reduces anxiety and shifts effort away from navigating the course toward engaging the material. Transparent rubrics and staged milestones are not bureaucratic devices; they are tools that make intellectual work legible.

In Econ 105, for example, students complete seven short analytical papers across thematic units. They choose when to submit within a structured window. The flexibility acknowledges real-life constraints; the cumulative design preserves rigor. Discussion posts extend the writing cycle into collective space, requiring students to articulate claims publicly and respond to peers. The classroom becomes a site of argument-building rather than passive reception.

Student feedback consistently highlights clarity, organization, and fairness of expectations. When pacing concerns surfaced—particularly in accelerated or redesigned formats—I adjusted sequencing, redistributed workload, and formalized reminder and feedback checkpoints. Structure remains central, but it evolves in response to evidence.

Argument Under Constraint

Political economy can easily become abstract. I insist that concepts must travel: from theory to claim, from claim to evidence, from evidence to inference. Assessments reward analytical coherence and disciplined reasoning rather than stylistic flourish.

In Econ 105, exams are essay-based. Students receive prompts in advance to prepare thoughtfully; the timed format ensures that synthesis occurs under realistic constraints. The goal is not performance anxiety, but disciplined integration. Students must decide what matters, what supports their claim, and what can be left aside.

Comments frequently link this rigor to later success in advanced programs and professional settings. In advising contexts, students report that explicit methodological feedback and structured revision cycles were decisive for completing theses on time. Where online platforms introduced friction or distraction, I simplified course architecture and centralized submission workflows. The principle remains constant: reduce noise so that reasoning can surface.

High-Support Rigor

Rigor without support becomes exclusionary; support without standards becomes symbolic. I treat rigor as a design problem. Demanding intellectual work is productive only when scaffolding is visible and feedback is reliable.

In seminar courses, weekly response papers function as skill formation exercises: identifying claims, reconstructing arguments, and formulating questions. In more technical settings, I provide analytical templates that distinguish argument from opinion and inference from assertion. Low-stakes assignments create space for practice before evaluation.

Mentorship evaluations consistently reflect high levels of clarity and trust. Students describe supervision as structured yet dialogic—an environment where expectations are firm but communication is open. When students identify obstacles—uncertainty about milestones, time constraints, or conceptual confusion—I respond by making supervision protocols explicit: meeting agendas, interim drafts, response-time norms.

Teaching, for me, is not the transmission of content but the cultivation of disciplined expla-

nation. Structure provides the frame; writing provides the training; feedback provides the correction. Over time, the goal is that students internalize this rhythm and carry it into their own work—wherever they choose to apply it.

2 Course Design Portfolio

This section presents course snapshots that translate syllabi into a concise account of learning goals, scaffolding, and assessment logic. Full syllabi are provided in the appendices.

2.1 Course Snapshot: Econ 105 — Introduction to Political Economy (Online Instructor, UMass Amherst, Fall 2025)

This course introduces students to U.S. and global political economy. It emphasizes that economic activity is embedded in legal, political, and cultural institutions, and that economies evolve historically. Major topics include capitalism, the economic role of government, inequality, unemployment, ecological constraints, crisis and stagnation since 2008, and competing economic alternatives.

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Explain core institutional features of capitalist economies and how they shape outcomes.
- Compare competing explanations of crisis, inequality, and unemployment using course frameworks.
- Analyze policy problems (state capacity, taxation, ecological regulation) using political economy reasoning.
- Write short analytical essays that integrate readings, concepts, and evidence with clear argument structure.
- Evaluate claims about the economy in public discourse by identifying assumptions, mechanisms, and missing evidence.

Signature assignments.

- **Seven short papers (2 pages):** progressive analytical writing across thematic units with flexible submission timing.
- **Canvas discussion prompts:** structured peer engagement focused on claim formation and critique.
- **Midterm and final exams (essay-based):** prompts provided in advance; time-constrained completion to reward synthesis and preparation.

Assessment logic: The course allocates 50% of the grade to continuous writing and discussion (short papers + posts) to build analytical habits; exams reward integrative synthesis. This design reduces high-stakes volatility and distributes evaluation across repeated demonstrations of competence.

AI policy framing: The course adopts an explicit ethical framework for AI-assisted writing centered on disclosure, verification, and accountability. The goal is not prohibition-as-theatre, but literacy: students learn how to validate claims and avoid fabricated references.

Skill progression: Units begin with foundational institutional concepts and build toward crisis theory, ecological political economy, and contemporary digital capitalism debates. Writing assignments move from concept explanation to comparative analysis and policy critique.

Full syllabus. See Appendix A.

2.2 Course Snapshot: Globalization and Development (First-Year Seminar, Wesleyan University, Fall 2021)

This first-year seminar uses the theme of “globalization and development” to train foundational academic skills (disciplined reading, structured writing, and evidence-based discussion) while introducing students to classic and contemporary debates on development and social change. The course opens by confronting disciplinary fragmentation in the social sciences and by practicing integrative approaches to explanation. It then moves through classical foundations (Marx and Weber), modernization and developmentalism, and critiques emerging from Latin American dependency and world-systems traditions. The final arc reframes globalization as a historically specific configuration of power, institutions, and uneven development, culminating in a focused engagement with neoliberalism and its contested legacies.

The course is intentionally structured around a *weekly writing cadence* (1–2 page response papers) to build reading stamina and reduce end-of-semester compression. Responses serve a dual function: they enforce systematic note-taking and synthesis, and they provide a stable evidence base for seminar discussion. Later in the semester, students shift from weekly responses to student-led presentations to practice oral argumentation and collective interpretation.

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Read social-science texts for argument structure (question, claim, mechanism, evidence) and produce concise analytical summaries.
- Compare foundational frameworks of development and social change (classical political economy, modernization/developmentalism, dependency/world-systems, feminist critiques).
- Explain globalization as an institutional and political-economic process (not merely “interdependence”), including its distributive and spatial consequences.
- Write short analytical essays that connect readings to a clear claim and a justified evaluation.
- Present and defend an interpretation of a scholarly chapter in a structured seminar format.

Signature assessments and logic.

- **Weekly response papers + participation (40%):** Repeated practice in synthesis and critique; responses seed discussion and reduce reading bottlenecks.
- **Midterm film essay (20%):** Students analyze a documentary through course concepts and targeted contextual research.
- **Student presentation (20%):** Each student leads a chapter-based session in the late-semester arc, replacing response papers during the presentation period.
- **Final take-home book review (20%):** A structured critical review of Harvey’s *A Brief History of Neoliberalism*, requiring engagement with external reviews as comparative evidence.

Core text anchor. Roberts, J. T., Hite, A. B., & Chorev, N. (Eds.). (2014). *The Globalization and Development Reader: Perspectives on Development and Global Change* (2nd ed.). Wiley.

Full syllabus. See Appendix B.

2.3 Course Snapshot: Political Economy of Latin American Development (Wesleyan University, Fall 2021)

This upper-level seminar introduces students to Latin American theories of development and underdevelopment while building the capacity to connect historical trajectories to competing explanatory frameworks. The course moves from classical development economics (industrialization debates, dual economy models, labor markets and migration) to core Latin American traditions (structuralism, coloniality/eurocentrism, marginality, dependency). It closes by examining ISI, the transition to neoliberalism, and long-run inequality dynamics across the twentieth century.

Learning outcomes. By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Distinguish major approaches in classical development economics (industrialization strategies, dual economy, migration and labor market debates).
- Explain key Latin American traditions of development thought (structuralism, dependency, marginality, coloniality) and compare their claims.
- Connect theoretical frameworks to historical processes (ISI, neoliberal transition, inequality trajectories) using evidence-based argumentation.
- Write analytically structured essays that integrate readings with clear claims, mechanisms, and critical evaluation.
- Develop an original research question and produce a term paper grounded in course debates and literature.

Signature assignments.

- **Weekly response papers (30%):** Short analytical responses that structure seminar discussion and train disciplined reading-to-argument habits.
- **Three take-home essays (30%):** 2,000–2,500 word essays with a 24-hour window, designed to reward synthesis across modules rather than summary.
- **Term paper (40%):** Proposal (10%) + presentation (10%) + final paper (20%), developed progressively and presented during the exam period.

Assessment logic. The course prioritizes repeated analytical writing under clear constraints. Weekly responses create a stable seminar rhythm and distribute participation. The take-home essays require students to integrate frameworks across readings. The term paper trains independent research design and argument construction, with staged milestones that reduce last-minute volatility and improve quality.

Core readings.

- Basu, K. (2003). *Analytical Development Economics: The Less Developed Economy Revisited*. MIT Press.
- Kay, C. (2010). *Latin American Theories of Development and Underdevelopment*. Routledge.

Course arc. Industrialization and the “big push” → dual economy and migration → structuralism → coloniality and eurocentrism → marginality → dependency → ISI, neoliberal transition, and inequality.

Full syllabus. See Appendix B.

2.4 Course Snapshot: Generative AI and the Political Economy of Digital Capitalism (Syllabus Prepared for an Application)

Course description (condensed). A course combining hands-on exposure to generative AI tools with political economy analysis of digital capitalism (data extraction, cloud infrastructure, platform power, governance). Students learn both applied skills (prompt

engineering, replicability) and critical frameworks (intellectual monopoly, platform-state relations).

Why this course fits my teaching identity. The course operationalizes “argument under constraint” in a domain where verification is not optional: students face hallucination risk, citation failure, and the politics of infrastructure in real time. Technical training (tools and workflows) is paired with institutional analysis (platform power, data extraction, cloud governance) so that students learn to connect mechanisms to control. Assessment is designed around replicability: students must produce prompt chains that another user can run independently, defend design choices, and document verification and disclosure practices. In this sense, the course functions as a laboratory in governance and literacy rather than a survey of tools.

Learning outcomes. Students learn to:

- Explain how AI systems are produced and governed within digital capitalism.
- Design reproducible prompt workflows and evaluate outputs critically.
- Analyze AI ethics and governance debates using political economy concepts.
- Communicate findings through structured writing and poster presentation.

Signature assignments. Prompt engineering group project, final poster + prompt set, structured participation, and take-home ethics exam. The course includes an AI-guided group formation exercise to make team design transparent and collectively governed.

Full syllabus. See Appendix B.

Taken together, these snapshots make the instructional logic legible: stable weekly rhythm, transparent criteria, and repeated practice in argument and evidence. The evaluation and mentorship evidence presented next should be read as a test of this design under different institutional constraints (seminar vs. online-accelerated vs. applied macro), not as isolated scores detached from pedagogy.

3 Teaching Practice, Trajectory, and Mentorship Impact

My teaching record reflects a structured progression across institutions, modalities, and levels of responsibility. What began as discussion and laboratory leadership at UMass Amherst (2016–2019) developed into instructor-of-record roles in introductory and upper-level political economy courses (UMass UWW, 2021–2023), seminar-based instruction at Wesleyan University (Fall 2021), and most recently, applied macroeconomic teaching in Chile (USACH, 2024). Across these contexts, the through-line is consistent: structured rigor, transparent expectations, iterative adjustment, and a deliberate integration of mentorship into course architecture.

Design principle: The trajectory is not merely institutional; it reflects increasing control over course design, assessment architecture, and feedback systems. Early experience in discussion sections established strengths in organization and clarity. The transition to online and accelerated formats required full redesign under platform constraints, producing the steepest learning curve in pacing, workload staging, and feedback cadence. Seminar teaching sharpened writing-intensive assessment and discussion facilitation. The most recent appointment reflects consolidation: applied macroeconomic instruction delivered within a stabilized course structure and accompanied by consistently strong evaluations for clarity and accessibility.

Course Type	Courses Taught	Role	Institution(s)
Intro / Core	Econ 105 (Intro to Political Economy); Econ 203 (Micro); Econ 204 (Macro)	Instructor of record	UMass UWW
Upper-level electives	Marxist Political Economy (Econ 305); Generative AI & Digital Capitalism	Instructor of record	UMass UWW
Discussion / Labs	Econ 103, 311, 452	TA / Lab leader	UMass Amherst (Main)
Seminars	Political Economy of Latin American Development and Labor; Globalization and Development (FYS)	Lecturer	Wesleyan University
Applied macro / policy-facing	Macroeconomics and Conjunctural Analysis	Professor	USACH

Table 1: Course coverage and instructional roles (selected).

Quantitative and Qualitative Evidence

Evaluation instruments differ across institutions (1–5, 1–9, 1–5), so scores are reported on their native scales and normalized as percentage-of-maximum where cross-institutional comparison is useful. The pattern is consistent across phases: strong ratings for clarity and organization, greater variance during periods of redesign, and consolidation in the most recent appointment.

AI assistance disclosure: The organization of evaluation text (theme coding) and the formatting of summary tables and figures were AI-assisted. All interpretations, claims, and final wording are mine, and all numeric values match the underlying evaluation reports available upon request.

Evidence: Table 2 reports overall evaluations by term and course.

Year/Term	Institution	Course	Role	Resp. Rate	Overall	Scale
2016 Fa	UMass (Main)	103 Disc/Lab	TA/Lab	44%	3.8	1–5
2019 Sp	UMass (Main)	311 Disc/Lab	TA/Lab	27%	4.0	1–5
2021 Sp	UMass (Main)	452 Lab	Lab Leader	42%	4.0	1–5
2021 Su	UMass UWW	105 Intro	Instructor	50%	4.0	1–5
2021 Fa	UMass UWW	105 Intro	Instructor	72%	3.5	1–5
2022 Su	UMass UWW	305 Marx	Instructor	29%	4.5	1–5
2023 Sp	UMass UWW	203 Micro	Instructor	25%	4.0	1–5
2023 Sp	UMass UWW	204 Macro	Instructor	33%	1.0	1–5
2021 Fa	Wesleyan	361 LatAm Dev/Labor	Lecturer	93%	4.5	1–9
2021 Fa	Wesleyan	168F Global- ization	Lecturer	88%	5.9	1–9
2024 Fa	USACH	Macro Con- junctural Analysis	Professor	—	4.5	1–5

Table 2: Overall teaching evaluations by term and course (native scales).

Normalized trajectories clarify the pattern. Figure 1 shows average performance by institutional phase. The early UMass Amherst period establishes a strong baseline. The UMass UWW phase shows increased dispersion during redesign and online transition. By 2024, ratings stabilize in the upper band, reflecting a mature course architecture and more reliable feedback systems.

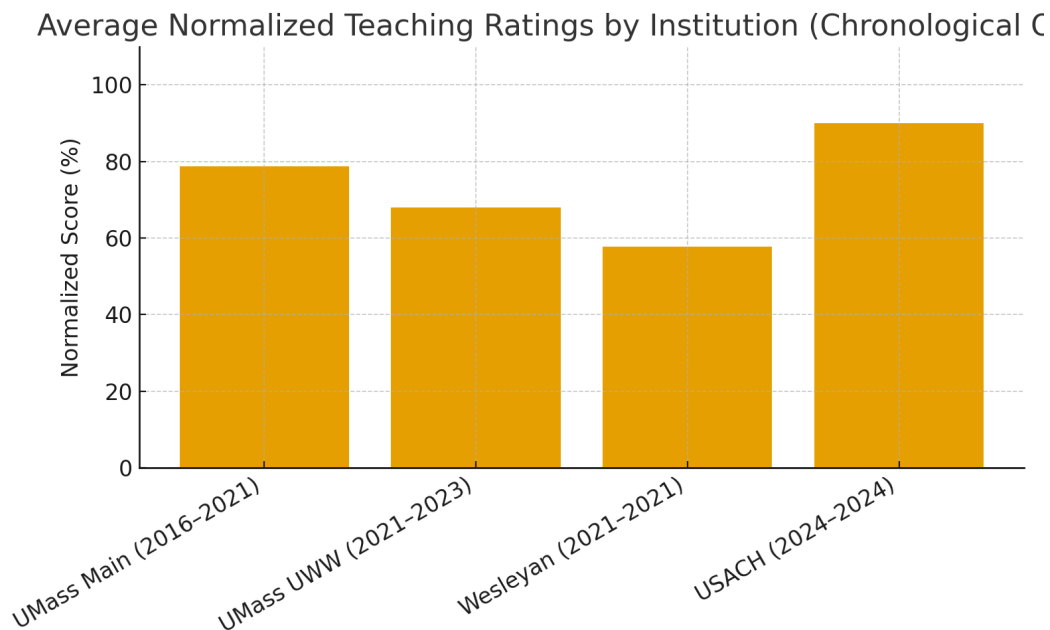


Figure 1: Average normalized teaching ratings by institutional phase.

How to read Figure 1. The key comparison is across institutional phases: a strong early baseline, increased dispersion during accelerated online redesign, and consolidation in the most recent appointment.

Figure 2 displays term-level dispersion. Variance rises during 2021–2023 as course structure was reworked under accelerated conditions; dispersion narrows again once pacing, platform governance, and feedback cadence were standardized.

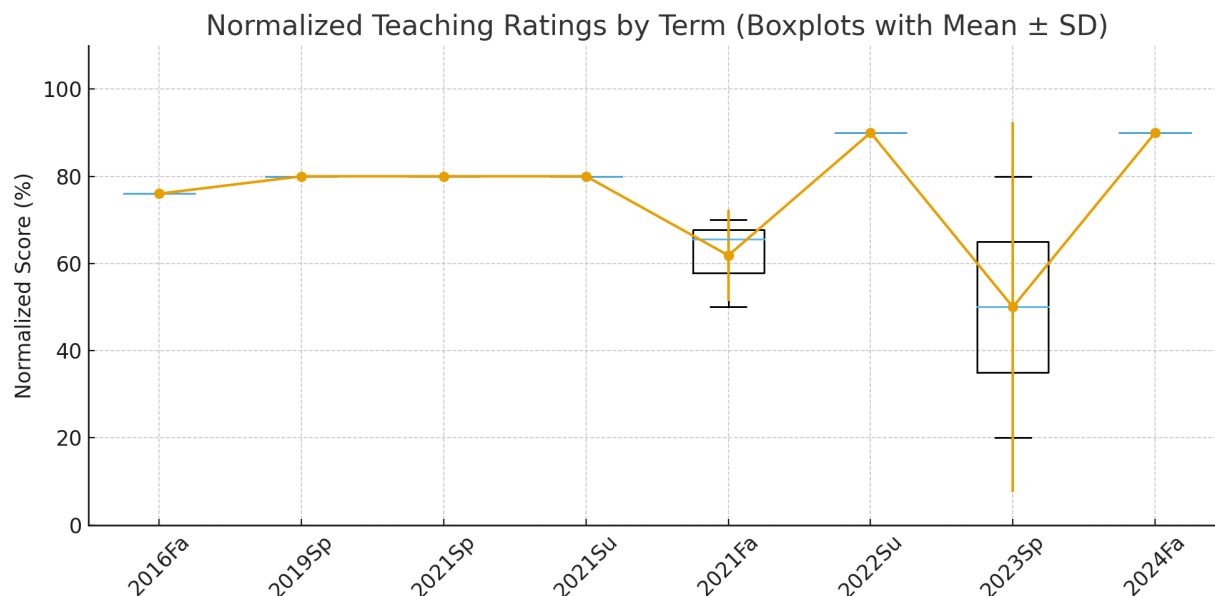


Figure 2: Normalized teaching ratings by term (boxplots with mean $\pm$ SD).

How to read Figure 2. Focus on dispersion rather than only the mean: the redesign phase exhibits wider spread, while the consolidation phase narrows dispersion and returns to the upper band, indicating stabilized pacing and feedback systems.

Adjustment: The Spring 2023 accelerated macro section represents an anomalous small- N case during platform transition. Rather than treat it as noise, I used it diagnostically. Workload sequencing was restaged, response-time norms formalized, and delivery centralized within a single instructor-governed architecture. Subsequent courses show reduced dispersion and stabilized ratings. The episode reinforced a practical rule: evaluation variance is information about course design under constraint, not an injury to be hidden.

Open-ended feedback clusters around four themes. First, organization and clarity are repeatedly cited as strengths. Second, rigor is described as preparation rather than punitive difficulty. Third, critiques concentrate on pacing and feedback timing during redesign phases. Fourth, students emphasize accessibility and technical depth in advisory relationships. These themes are consistent across institutions and align with the structural adjustments described above.

3.1 Mentorship as Structured Extension of Teaching

Carry-forward rule: Mentorship in my practice is not ancillary; it is the scaled extension of course design. The same logic that governs weekly assignments governs thesis supervision: early topic definition, staged milestones, explicit criteria for drafts, and predictable feedback intervals.

Mentoring evaluations collected in 2024 (1–7 scale) show high central tendency with minimal dispersion (clarity of guidance: mean 6.8; interpersonal relationship: mean 6.8; valued aspects: mean 7.0). While the sample size is small, the ceiling pattern aligns with qualitative comments emphasizing reliability, respect, and technical support.

Representative cases illustrate the continuity between classroom rigor and advising outcomes. Former students have progressed to graduate study, data science, finance, and law. In each case, feedback emphasizes two elements: structured analytical expectations and sustained dialogic support. Students consistently describe demanding coursework and supervision as formative rather than exclusionary.

In sum, the arc across institutions and roles is coherent. Early teaching established organizational discipline. Redesign phases introduced variance and produced structural reform. Subsequent appointments reflect consolidation. Mentorship operates within the same architecture: high expectations paired with explicit scaffolding and reliable feedback. The evidence—quantitative, qualitative, and professional outcomes—supports the claim that structured rigor, when made transparent and adjustable, generates durable learning and trust.

3.2 Forward Commitments: A Stable Improvement Model

My improvement model is organized as a repeatable workflow rather than an informal intention: design → diagnostic feedback → targeted adjustment → re-assessment. Three practices are now standardized across modalities.

Early-term scaffolding (Weeks 1–2). I front-load navigation and expectations to prevent avoidable ambiguity: a course map, a sample high-scoring submission, and a short guide clarifying what counts as analysis versus summary.

Mid-course diagnostics (Weeks 4–6). I run a short, structured check-in focused on pacing, feedback timing, and workload staging. The aim is to identify frictions early enough to correct them while the course is still in motion.

Feedback governance (continuous). I standardize response-time norms and grading criteria so that rigor remains credible and support remains reliable. This includes a predictable cadence for written feedback, stable rubrics aligned to learning outcomes, and a single-platform workflow that reduces administrative friction for students.

These commitments preserve the objective that organizes the dossier as a whole: high-structure teaching that supports student agency, analytical integrity, and durable skills in reasoning and evidence.

A Appendix A: Econ 105 Syllabus (Fall 2025)

Subject Matter of this Course

This course introduces students to the U.S. and global economies. The *political–economy* approach emphasises that economic activity is embedded in a society’s legal, political and cultural institutions and that the economy evolves over time. Topics include the basic principles of a capitalist economy, the economic role of government, environmental problems, inequality, unemployment, economic crisis and stagnation since 2008, and economic alternatives.

Textbook and Readings

The required textbook for this course is:

- Samuel Bowles, Richard Edwards & Frank Roosevelt, *Understanding Capitalism: Competition, Command, and Change*, 4th ed. (2018).

Non-Required but suggested readings will be provided from:

- Rochon, L. & Rossi, S. (Eds.). (2023). *Elgar encyclopedia of post-Keynesian economics*. Edward Elgar Publishing.
- Vidal, M., Smith, T., Rotta, T., & Prew, P. (Eds.). (2019). *The Oxford Handbook of Karl Marx*. Oxford University Press.
- Basu, D. (2022). *The logic of capital: An introduction to marxist economic theory*. Cambridge University Press.
- Dunn, B. (2014). *The Political Economy of Global Capitalism and Crisis*. Routledge.

The textbook is available through campus booksellers or online retailers. Additional required readings will be provided by the professor on a section-by-section basis and posted on Canvas. Students are responsible for accessing and completing these readings as scheduled.

Course Requirements

- **Seven short papers.** These short essays (2 pages) will be posted on Canvas and you'll have flexibility to decide when to take them before a deadline.
- **Five discussion prompts** posted on Canvas and answered online.
- **One midterm exam** Essay based but time constrained. Exam questions will be presented to you in advance, for you to prepare and research about it, but will be held on Canvas with a time constraint under a flexible window span.
- **One final exam** Same as the midterm.

Course Requirement Weights

Table 3: Assignments and Weights on Final Grade

Requirement	% of final grade
Final Exam	25 %
Midterm Exam	25 %
Short Papers	35 %
Discussion posts	15 %

Grading Schema

- **A** (90 % and above): excellent understanding with clear explanations and no significant errors.
- **B** (80–89 %): good understanding with minor areas needing improvement.
- **C** (70–79 %): fair understanding with several errors.
- **D** (60–69 %): minimal understanding.
- **F** (below 60 %): no demonstrable understanding.

Pluses and minuses occupy the upper and lower three points of each range (e.g., 77 = C+, 92 = A-). Discussion posts are graded for clarity, effort and thoughtfulness rather than correctness.

Make-up Exams

Permission to take a make-up exam must be obtained from the instructor before the scheduled exam time. Make-up exams are granted only for documented reasons such as illness or injury. Travel plans are not a valid reason to miss an exam.

Academic Honesty

All work must be your own. You must not present any portion of another person's work — including AI-generated text — as your own. Generative AI tools raise concerns around plagiarism, hallucinated content and fabricated references. If you choose to use such tools to support your work, you must follow the principles articulated by Cheng et.al.(2025) for ethical AI-assisted academic writing:

1. **Transparency:** Clearly disclose any AI assistance in your submission.
2. **Critical review:** Edit AI-generated output to ensure accuracy, originality and alignment with your own ideas.
3. **Verification:** Confirm the validity of all facts, citations and references.
4. **Accountability:** You remain responsible for the final product, regardless of AI use.

Failure to adhere to these principles or to properly cite sources may constitute plagiarism and will result in a grade of **F** on the assignment or exam. A notice summarizing the use of AI under ethical principles — along with a copy of Cheng et al. (2025) — will be posted on Canvas as a reference.

Reference: Cheng, A., Calhoun, A. & Reedy, G. (2025). Artificial intelligence-assisted academic writing: Recommendations for ethical use. *Advances in Simulation*, 10(1), 22.

Course Website and Communication with the Instructor

This is a Canvas course. All enrolled students have access through UMass Canvas. Discussion posts, assignment descriptions, selected readings complementing the main textbook, and

announcements will be posted there. It is expected that you review your UMass email frequently, as the instructor might directly communicate with you there.

Readings

This is a 4-credit course. The volume of reading is greater than for a typical 3-credit course. Selections from *Understanding Capitalism* are the most intensive; other selected readings will be posted in Canvas by the instructor.

Reading Assignments by Topic

1. **Introduction** – *Understanding Capitalism* chs. 1 & 3 (all).
2. **Human Nature and Economic Behaviour** – *Understanding Capitalism* ch. 2; Johnson, “In Search of the Affluent Society”; Harris, “Potlatch.”
3. **Production, Reproduction and Economic Surplus** – *Understanding Capitalism* ch. 4.
4. **Markets** – *Understanding Capitalism* chs. 8 & 9.
5. **Economic Systems** – *Understanding Capitalism* ch. 5, pp. 89–96.
6. **Capitalism** – *Understanding Capitalism* ch. 5 (pp. 96–112), ch. 7 (pp. 132–137), ch. 10 (pp. 207–220); Weisskopf, “Sources of Cyclical Downturns.” Basu, D. (2022). *The Logic of Capital: An Introduction to Marxist Economic Theory*. Cambridge University Press. pp. 137–143.
7. **Capitalism and the U.S. Economy** – *Understanding Capitalism* ch. 7 (pp. 137–141); *Selected readings to be posted on Canvas*.
8. **The Government and the Economy** – *Understanding Capitalism* ch. 6; ch. 19 (pp. 516–527); supplemented by *Dunn*, ch. 6.
9. **The Global Economy** – *Understanding Capitalism* ch. 17 (pp. 435–447) and Dunn (2014) chs. 7–8–9.
10. **The Economy and the Natural Environment** – Boyce (2003); Boyce (2025); choose one of Moore (2022) or Frame (2022).

11. **Inequality** – *Understanding Capitalism*, ch. 14 (all).
12. **Unemployment and Business Cycles** – *Understanding Capitalism*, ch. 16 (all); Gould & de Courcy (2024).
13. **Social Structures of Accumulation: Institutions, Stagnation, and Crisis** – *Understanding Capitalism*, ch. 7; Kotz (2009); choose one of Pagano (2014) or Cox (2019).
14. **Contemporary Capitalism and Economic Alternatives** – Durand & Milberg (2020); Rikap (2023); Morozov (2019); Muldoon (2025).

Course Schedule – Fall 2025

The calendar below aligns the thematic units with the UMass Amherst Fall 2025 academic calendar. Unless otherwise noted, assignments are due at 11:59 p.m. Eastern time on the due date.

Week	Topics	Assignment	Due Date
0	Introduction	Discussion 1 (Unit 1)	Mon Sept 8
1	Human Nature & Economic Behaviour	Short Paper 1 (Unit 2)	Mon Sept 15
2	Production, Reproduction & Surplus	Discussion 2 (Unit 3)	Wed Sept 17
3	Markets	Short Paper 2 (Unit 4)	Fri Sept 26
4	Economic Systems	Discussion 3 (Unit 5)	Wed Oct 1 (Post); Fri Oct 3 (Reply)
5	Capitalism	Short Paper 3 (Unit 6)	Fri Oct 10
6	Capitalism & the U.S. Economy	Midterm Exam (Unit 7)	Fri Oct 24
7	Government & Economy	Short Paper 4 (Unit 8)	Fri Oct 31
8	The Global Economy	Discussion 4 (Unit 9)	Wed Nov 5 (Post); Fri Nov 7 (Reply)

Week	Topics	Assignment	Due Date
9	Economy & Natural Environment	Discussion 5 (Unit 10)	Wed Nov 12 (Post); Fri Nov 14 (Reply)
		Short Paper 5	Fri Nov 21
10	Inequality	Discussion 6	Mon Nov 24
11	Unemployment & Business Cycles	Short Paper 6 (Unit 11)	Wed Dec 3
12	Social Structures of Accumulation	Short Paper 7 (Unit 12)	Tue Dec 9
13	Digital Capitalism & Alternatives	Exam Material (Unit 14)	—
Final Exam (Units 12–13): during the university exam period (Dec 11–17).			

B Appendix B: Additional Syllabi (as provided)

B.1 Globalization and Development (First-Year Seminar – Wesleyan University, Fall 2021)

Course Description

This class aims to provide first-year students with critical skills to succeed in their undergraduate studies while introducing them to classic and contemporary discussions on development and globalization. Before engaging core course themes, we begin with the contemporary fragmentation of the social sciences and examine integrative approaches to understanding social change. The course then studies foundational contributions from classic authors such as Karl Marx and Max Weber, followed by modernization and developmentalism and critiques from the Latin American Dependency School. Building on these debates, we consider contemporary approaches informed by the rise of East Asia and feminist development theory. Finally, we examine what globalization is and how to approach development and social change in the current globalization era.

A core pedagogical objective is to improve students' reading capabilities both quantitatively and qualitatively. Students are expected to complete readings before class and to submit brief response papers on a weekly basis (1–2 pages). This structure is designed to build systematic reading habits and reduce end-of-semester workload spikes. Response papers have a double objective: they require students to synthesize key arguments and develop a critical assessment, while also building writing skills. These submissions also serve as material for the instructor to motivate classroom participation.

Textbook

- Roberts, J. T., Hite, A. B., & Chorev, N. (Eds.). (2014). *The Globalization and Development Reader: Perspectives on Development and Global Change*. John Wiley & Sons. Second Edition. (RHC)

Class Assignments and Grading Scheme

- **Response Papers and Class Participation (40%)**

Students submit a short response paper on the assigned readings. These demonstrate completion of readings and provide material to support seminar discussion.

- **Midterm: Movie Essay (20%)**

Students are randomly assigned a movie and a corresponding question. Students may trade assignments if they notify the instructor by a deadline (TBD). The essay requires engaging with course readings and discussions and doing additional research on the film's context. Minimum and maximum length: TBD.

- **Student Presentations (20%)**

In the latter section of the semester, each student presents a chapter from later sections of RHC. No response papers are required during the presentation period.

- **Final Exam: Book Review (20%)**

Take-home final examination: a book review of:

Harvey, D. (2007). *A Brief History of Neoliberalism*. Oxford University Press.

Students must engage with Harvey's argument using course readings and discussions, and critically engage with existing published reviews as comparative evidence. The reading is

accessible, but the interpretive range is wide. Students are encouraged to begin reading early in the semester.

Policies and Rules

Grading Policy. Grades come from four essay assignments (books and documentaries) alongside structured questions with word-count expectations, plus in-class participation. Essays collectively account for the majority of the grade, with participation graded through active engagement in seminar discussion.

Academic Integrity. Wesleyan University has an Honor Code. Students are expected to abide by it throughout the course. Students are encouraged to discuss essay assignments with peers, and collaborative discussion is permitted. However, students must submit their own work. The instructor may verify that students are developing their own answers and arguments.

Code of Conduct. The course follows Wesleyan University standards to create a classroom free of discrimination, intimidation, and harassment. This applies to interactions among students and between students and the instructor. The course will engage difficult topics and disagreement is expected; discussion must remain respectful and oriented toward learning. Students should alert the instructor to any issues so they can be addressed promptly.

Students with Disabilities. Wesleyan University provides reasonable accommodations to students with documented disabilities. Students are responsible for registering with Disability Services and for notifying the instructor in a timely manner. If accommodations are needed, students should schedule a meeting with the instructor as early as possible (ideally within the first two weeks). If conditions change during the semester, students should coordinate with Disability Services and relevant university offices as appropriate.

Class Overview

Introduction (2 classes)

- **Class 1: Introduction**

Hite, A. B., Roberts, J. T., & Chorev, N. (2014). “Globalization and Development: Recurring Themes.” In RHC, pp. 1–17.

- **Class 2: Approaches to Social Sciences**

Wallerstein, I. (2000). “Open the Social Sciences.” *Asia-Pacific Social Science Review*, 1(1), 1–1.

Jessop, B., & Sum, N. L. (2001). “Pre-disciplinary and Post-disciplinary Perspectives.” *New Political Economy*, 6(1), 89–101.

Formative Approaches to Development and Social Change (5 classes)

- **Class 3: “The Classics”: Marx and Weber**

RHC Introduction, Section I, Chapters 1–2.

- **Class 4: Developmentalism**

RHC Chapters 3–4.

- **Class 5: Poverty and Democracy**

RHC Chapters 5–6.

- **Class 6: The Nation**

Poulantzas, N. (2008). “The Nation.” In Brenner, N., Jessop, B., Jones, M., & Macleod, G. (Eds.), *State/Space: A Reader*. Wiley.

Dependency and Beyond (4 classes)

- **Classes 7–8: Dependency Theory and World-System Analysis**

RHC Part II Introduction; Chapters 7–9.

- **Class 9: Rethinking Development Theory**

RHC Chapters 10–11.

- **Class 10: Feminism and Development**
RHC Chapters 12–13.

What is Globalization? (4 classes)

- **Class 11: The New International Division of Labour**
RHC Part III Introduction and Chapter 14 (pp. 227–246).
- **Class 12: In Defense of Global Capitalism**
RHC Chapters 15–16.
- **Classes 13–15: Neoliberalism**
Brenner, N., & Theodore, N. (2002). “Cities and the Geographies of ‘Actually Existing Neoliberalism.’” *Antipode*, 34(3), 349–379.
RHC Chapters 17–19.

Development after Globalization (2 classes)

- **Student presentations:** RHC Chapters 21–26.

Global Themes: Searching for a New Paradigm

- Selected chapters from the last section of RHC (to be assigned).

Political Economy of Latin American Development (Taught at Wesleyan University during Fall 2021)

Instructor: Diego Polanco (Wesleyan University)

Contact: dpolancone@umass.edu

Term: Fall 2021

Course Description

This course provides an overview of Latin American theories of development and underdevelopment, with the goal of enabling students to engage historical and contemporary debates about the region's past, present, and future. The core arc moves from classical development economics (industrialization debates and the “big push,” dual-economy frameworks, labor markets and migration) to Latin American theoretical traditions (structuralism, colonialism/eurocentrism, marginality, dependency). The course closes by examining industrialization and the political economy of Import Substitution Industrialization (ISI), the transition to neoliberalism, and long-run inequality dynamics across the twentieth century.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Distinguish major approaches in classical development economics (industrialization strategies, dual economy, migration and labor market debates).
- Explain key Latin American traditions of development thought (structuralism, dependency, marginality, coloniality) and compare their claims.
- Connect theoretical frameworks to historical processes (ISI, neoliberal transition, inequality trajectories) using evidence-based argumentation.
- Write analytically structured essays that integrate course readings with clear claims, mechanisms, and critical evaluation.
- Develop an original research question and produce a term paper grounded in the course debates and literature.

Core References

- Basu, K. (2003). *Analytical Development Economics: The Less Developed Economy Revisited*. MIT Press.
- Kay, C. (2010). *Latin American Theories of Development and Underdevelopment*. Routledge.

Further Book and Dissertation References (Selected)

- Roberts, J. T., Hite, A. B., & Chorev, N. (Eds.). (2014). *The Globalization and Development Reader*. Wiley.
- Leiva, F. I. (2008). *Latin American Neostructuralism*. University of Minnesota Press.
- Sanyal, K. (2014). *Rethinking Capitalist Development*. Routledge.
- Lagos, F. (2017). *The Misadventures of Latin American Marxism* (Doctoral dissertation).
- Clark, T. D. (2013). *The State and the Making of Capitalist Modernity in Chile* (Doctoral dissertation).

Assessment and Grading

Grades are based on analytical writing and structured participation:

- **Weekly response papers and participation (30%):** Short weekly responses to the assigned readings. These responses function as (i) reading accountability, (ii) structured note-taking, and (iii) input for seminar discussion.
- **Three short essays (30%):** Three take-home essays (2000–2500 words) with a 24-hour time window once prompts are released. Prompts are designed to require integration across readings rather than summary.
- **Term paper (40%):** A research paper developed over the semester and presented during the examination period.

Term paper components.

- Proposal (10%)
- Presentation (10%)
- Final paper (20%)

Academic Integrity

Wesleyan University's Honor Code applies. Collaboration and discussion are encouraged for developing ideas and improving analytical reasoning, but all submitted essays must be written independently. The instructor may verify originality and that students are developing their own answers and arguments.

Code of Conduct

The course follows Wesleyan's standards to maintain a classroom free of discrimination, intimidation, and harassment. Discussions may address difficult topics and disagreement is expected; all engagement must remain respectful and oriented toward learning.

Accessibility and Accommodations

Students requiring accommodations should register with Disability Services and inform the instructor early (ideally within the first two weeks). Accommodations can be adjusted if conditions change during the semester.

Course Structure and Reading Plan (Overview)

The course is organized into the following modules. "Required" readings are listed to preserve the original course design; additional supplementary readings may be assigned during the term.

1. Motivation: Political Economy of Latin American Development (1 class)

Screening/discussion: John Leguizamo, *Latin History for Morons* (Netflix).

2. Classical Development Economics: Industrialization and the "Big Push" (Classes 2–3)

Required: Basu (Ch. 1–2); Rostow (1960, Ch. 3 in Roberts et al. 2014); Gerschenkron (1962, Ch. 4 in Roberts et al. 2014); Chang (2003).

Suggested: Rosenstein-Rodan (1943); Nurkse (1952); Skott & Ros (1997).

3. Dual Economy, Labor Markets, and Migration (Classes 4–6)

Required: Gollin (2014); Basu (Ch. 7–8); Hart (1973); Fields (1975).

Suggested: ILO Kenya (1972, Summary); Lewis (1954); Harris & Todaro (1970); La Porta & Shleifer (2014); García-Andrés et al. (2018).

Short essay 1 reading: Lewis (1982).

4. Latin American Theories I: Introduction (Class 7)

Required: Kay (Ch. 1).

Suggested: Palma (2009).

5. Latin American Theories II: Structuralism (Classes 7–9)

Required: Kay (Ch. 2); Caldentey & Vernengo (2016); Ahumada (2019, Ch. 2); Basu (Ch. 4).

Suggested: Palma (2008); Prebisch (1950).

6. Latin American Theories III: Colonialism and Eurocentrism (Classes 9–11)

Required: Kay (Ch. 3); Quijano (2000); Lagos-Rojas (2019); Bértola et al. (2010); González & Montero (2010).

Suggested: Williamson (2010); Lagos dissertation (selected chapters).

Short essay 2 (film): *Nostalgia for the Light* (Patricio Guzmán).

7. Latin American Theories IV: Marginality (Classes 12–13)

Required: Kay (Ch. 4); Quijano (1974); Moser (1978); Portes (1978).

Suggested: Roberts (2013); Kesar & Bhattacharya (2020).

8. Latin American Theories V: Dependency (Classes 14–15)

Required: Kay (Ch. 5–6); Palma (1978); Kvangraven (2021).

Suggested: Frank (1969); Cardoso (1972); Wallerstein (1979).

Short essay 3 reading: Sanyal (2014).

9. Inequality, ISI, and Neoliberalism (Classes 16–20)

Required: Brenner & Theodore (2002); Silva (2007); Clark (2015); Palma (2014); Frankema (2010); Rodríguez Weber (2015); Webber (2017); Leiva (2008, selected chapters TBD).

Suggested: Harvey (2007, selected); Peck & Theodore (2007); Brenner et al. (2010); Clark (2017); Loureiro (2018, 2019, 2020); Lluch & Salvaj (2014); Bucheli et al. (2019).

B.2 Generative AI and the Political Economy of Digital Capitalism

Course Description

This course explores the development and application of generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Stable Diffusion, Bard/Claude) while critically engaging with their emergence within contemporary digital capitalism. Using Kulkarni et al. (2023) as a practical guide and theoretical readings from Rikap (2021) and Lehdonvirta (2022), students build both hands-on competence and analytical capacity. We investigate technical foundations and the social, economic, and ethical implications of AI across circuits of data extraction, platform control, and cloud infrastructure.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Explain core technical concepts behind generative AI systems (tokens, transformers, diffusion models) at an introductory level.
- Design reproducible prompt workflows and evaluate outputs for validity, bias, and failure modes.
- Analyze AI as an institutional and political-economic system (data, infrastructure, monopoly power, governance).
- Communicate findings through written analysis and visual presentation, using transparent documentation.
- Apply an ethical framework for AI-assisted academic work, including disclosure and verification.

Required Textbook

- Kulkarni, A., Gudivada, D., Kulkarni, A., & Shivananda, A. (2023). *Applied Generative AI for Beginners*. Springer Nature. (**AGAI**)

Selected Readings

- Rikap, C. (2021). *Capitalism, Power and Innovation: Intellectual Monopoly Capitalism Uncovered*. Routledge. *(selected extracts)*
- Lehdonvirta, V. (2022). *Cloud Empires: How Digital Platforms Are Overtaking the State and How We Can Regain Control*. MIT Press. *(selected extracts)*
- Additional journal articles on AI governance, circuits of extraction, and AI ethics will be provided.

Assignments and Evaluation

- **Midterm Prompt Engineering Project (25%):** Teams build a generative AI system that completes a defined task. Deliverables include goal definition, prompt logic, rubric, and documented outputs.
- **Final Poster + Prompt Set (25%):** Reproducible prompt chain + visual poster presented in a university-wide session.
- **Participation and Reading Responses (20%):** Engagement in lectures, team formation discussions, and two short response papers.
- **Take-Home Final Exam on AI Ethics (30%):** Analytical essay on ethical and governance issues in AI.

Collaborative Project Details

The midterm project focuses on prompt engineering: teams design a system that performs a practical or creative task and justify design choices. The final project requires a poster and a prompt package that an independent user can run. Replicability is part of the grade.

AI-Guided Group Formation Activity

During Weeks 1–2, the class designs a short survey that will be used for AI-assisted team assignment. Students jointly determine what attributes (skills, availability, interests, con-

straints) are included and how they are weighted. The goal is to make team formation transparent, collectively governed, and aligned with course learning objectives.

Academic Honesty and Use of AI

All submitted work must represent the student's own thinking and writing. AI tools may be used only as *assistance*, not as substitution. Any AI assistance must be disclosed. If students use AI tools to support drafting, brainstorming, coding, or summarizing, they must follow these principles (adapted from Cheng et al., 2025):

1. **Transparency:** Disclose any AI assistance (tool, purpose, and where it was used).
2. **Critical review:** Edit and rewrite to ensure originality and alignment with the student's argument.
3. **Verification:** Check factual claims, citations, and references. Fabricated citations or unverifiable sources are treated as academic misconduct.
4. **Accountability:** The student is responsible for the final product regardless of tool use.

Failure to disclose AI assistance, presenting AI-generated text as one's own, or submitting fabricated references may constitute plagiarism and will result in a grade of **F** on the assignment or exam.

Accessibility and Accommodations

Students with disabilities or learning differences are encouraged to contact Disability Services and inform the instructor as early as possible to ensure appropriate accommodations.

Make-up Policy

Permission to take a make-up exam must be obtained in advance and will be granted only for documented reasons (e.g., illness, family emergency). Travel plans or social obligations do not qualify.

Course Schedule Overview

Week	Topics and Assignments	Readings
1	Introduction to Generative AI	AGAI Ch. 1
2	Tokens, Transformers, and LLMs	AGAI Ch. 2
3	ChatGPT, Bard, Claude	AGAI Ch. 3
4	Diffusion Models: Images & Audio	AGAI Ch. 4
5	Prompt Engineering I + Group Discussion	AGAI Ch. 5
6	Prompt Engineering II + Finalize Teams	AGAI Ch. 6
7	Team Project Coaching	AGAI Ch. 7
8	Midterm Presentations	—
9	Platforms, Capital & Data	Lehdonvirta (selected extracts)
10	Intellectual Monopoly & Cloud Control	Rikap (selected extracts)
11	AI Labor & Extraction	Rikap (selected extracts)
12	Governance & Public Infrastructure	Lehdonvirta (selected extracts)
13	Poster Prep + Mock Demos	—
14	Poster Presentations (University Session)	—
15	AI Ethics & Take-Home Final Exam	Rikap; Lehdonvirta (selected extracts)

C Appendix C: Sample Assignment

Sample Assignment (ECON 361): Film–Theory Analytical Dossier

Nostalgia for the Light and the Political Economy of Knowledge

Purpose. This assignment treats Patricio Guzmán’s documentary *Nostalgia for the Light* as an analytical entry point into the political economy of knowledge production in Latin America. Students will connect the film to debates on enclave development, megascience, knowledge spillovers, institutional power, and memory conflict in Chile. The assignment is designed to move beyond film summary and toward mechanism-based explanation.

Submission format.

- Length: 2,500–3,000 words (double-spaced).
- File: PDF, submitted on Canvas.
- Citations: minimum 5–7 academic references (course readings count).
- Window: 24 hours after the prompt is released.

Core question. *How does *Nostalgia for the Light* illuminate the political economy of knowledge production in Chile, and what does this imply for the distribution of power in the era of data-driven technological change?*

Required structure and tasks

Your submission must be organized using the following sections (use headings exactly as written):

1. Conceptual architecture (20%).

Define and operationalize the following concepts as analytical tools (do not merely summarize):

- “Natural laboratories” and “megascience”

- Knowledge spillovers (vertical vs. horizontal)
- Enclave development
- “Memoria emblemática” (Stern)
- Strategic-relational approach (Jessop): institutions, selectivity, and power

2. Sectoral political economy of Chilean astronomy (20%).

Using the relevant readings, analyze whether Chilean astronomy operates as an enclave sector. Your answer must identify mechanisms rather than list features. Address:

- Who controls infrastructure and data flows?
- What spillover channels exist (skills, procurement, research networks, public investment)?
- What is the role of the state (policy, regulation, bargaining capacity)?
- Who is positioned to capture benefits and why?

3. Film analysis as political economy (20%).

Select 3–4 concrete scenes or sequences and use them as evidence. For each, briefly describe what happens and then analyze:

- How the film constructs the parallel between astronomy and memory
- How hierarchies of knowledge and visibility are represented
- How the desert functions as both laboratory and grave

Do not summarize the entire film.

4. The data turn and “open knowledge” (15%).

Evaluate the claim that open-source or open-data infrastructures transform power relations. Address:

- Does open data imply democratized power? Why or why not?
- What determines absorptive capacity (skills, institutions, finance, networks)?
- Under what conditions do spillovers become broadly social rather than narrowly captured?

5. Memory as political economy (15%).

Using Stern’s typology and relevant course frameworks:

- Which memory regime dominates in Chile in the period implied by the film?

- How does the film intervene in that struggle?
- Can “data science of memory” plausibly transform the “memory box” without institutional change?

6. **Critical evaluation (10%).**

Critically assess the proposal of a “data science of memory”:

- Is the proposal feasible as policy, as institutional reform, or as political strategy?
- What institutional changes would be required for it to work?
- What are the main risks or limits (capture, depoliticization, data governance)?

Evaluation criteria (rubric summary)

- **Conceptual precision (25%):** correct definitions and disciplined use of concepts.
- **Mechanism tracing (20%):** clear causal/relational logic (who benefits, through what channels, under what constraints).
- **Theory–evidence integration (20%):** film scenes used as evidence to advance an argument.
- **Political economy depth (20%):** institutions, power, and distribution addressed explicitly.
- **Coherence and writing quality (15%):** structure, clarity, and proper citation practice.

Common failure modes (avoid these)

- Plot summary in place of analysis.
- Treating memory as purely cultural rather than institutional and political.
- Ignoring the technological/industrial dimension (megascience, data infrastructures).
- Declaring normative positions without analytical support.
- Equating “open data” with equality or democratization without specifying mechanisms.

Optional extension (Extra Credit: +5%)

Draft a one-page mini research proposal for a “data science of memory” project:

- Research question
- Data source(s)
- Method (e.g., GIS, text-as-data, archival digitization, network analysis)
- Institutional and political implications

D Appendix D: Rubric Excerpt

D.1 Rubric Excerpt: ECON 105 Short Papers (Introduction to Political Economy)

The following rubric guides evaluation of 2–3 page analytical short papers in ECON 105. The design reflects three pedagogical priorities: (i) conceptual mastery, (ii) structured writing as a core economic skill, and (iii) narrative integration over mechanical listing of concepts.

Evaluation Criteria (100 points total)

Category	Points
Content & Conceptual Mastery	50
Accurate definition of required concepts	20
At least one concrete real-world example per concept	15
Reflection on interconnections, tensions, or contradictions	15
Writing & Structure	30
Introduction with a clear hook and framing claim	5
Logical paragraph organization and transitions	10
Conclusion that synthesizes argument	5
Conciseness, clarity, and flow	10
Style & Engagement	20
Narrative voice and intellectual risk-taking	10
Audience awareness and readability	10

Table 6: Rubric for ECON 105 Short Analytical Essays

Pedagogical Emphasis

The rubric rewards:

- Integration of concepts into a coherent narrative rather than mechanical definition.
- Use of contemporary or historical examples to ground theory.
- Clear paragraph structure and transitions.
- Writing craft as part of economic reasoning.
- Intellectual boldness, when paired with clarity and rigor.

Students are reminded that good economic writing requires imagining a reader who is attentive but time-constrained; clarity and structure are therefore decisive.

AI-Ethics Policy

Limited use of AI tools is permitted if aligned with ethical standards. Submissions must:

- Clearly disclose AI assistance.
- Maintain human authorship of ideas and analysis.
- Verify all references and claims.
- Demonstrate substantial independent reasoning.

Failure to comply with ethical AI standards may result in a grade penalty, while maintaining a minimum grade floor of 50 points.

A model disclosure statement is provided to students when AI use is evident but ethically consistent.